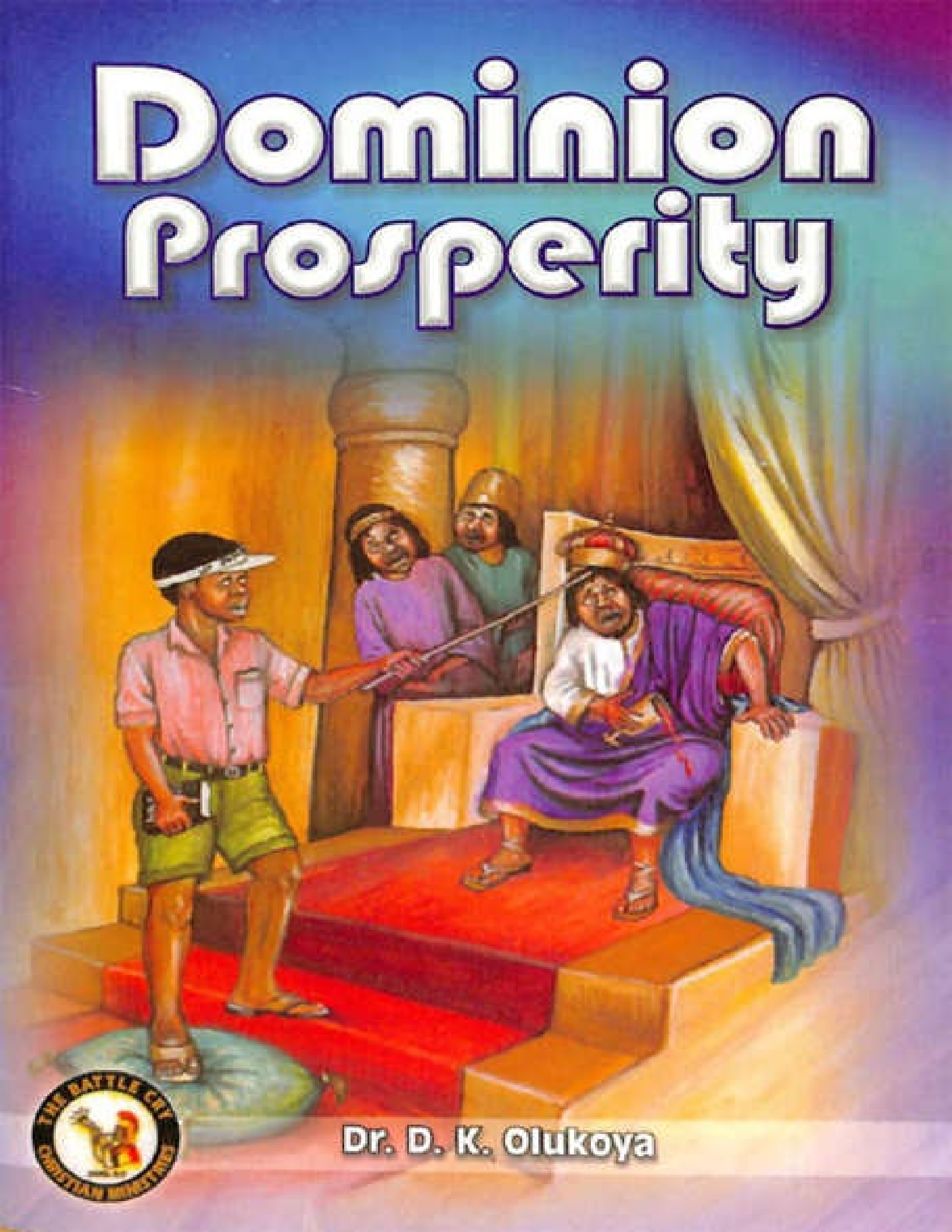
Dominion Prosperity



Dr. D. K. Olukoya

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DR. D. K. OLUKOYA

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UNITED KINGDOM

email: battlecrybooks@hotmail.com

website: www.battlecrybooks.com

Phone: 07947 653263

UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

email: jadetola71@aol.com / mfmatl@hotmail.com

website: www.battlecryusa.org

Phone (Mobile): (0787)606-2786 or (404) 641-8700

NIGERIA

11, Gbeto Street, off Iyana Church Bus Stop, Iwaya Road, Iwaya, Yaba, P. O. Box 12272, Ikeja, Lagos.

website: www.battlecrynig.com

email: battlecrynig@representative.com

Phone: 0803-304-4239, 0803-332-2376, 0803-306-0073, 0802-303-3938, 0803-309-8246, 0803-3 15-7249, 0803-3054142

GHANA

Phone: 24236113

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PRAYING TO KILL AFFLICTION

I shall precede this message with three Scriptures:

Many are the afflictions of the righteous: but the LORD delivereth him out of them all. He keepeth all his bones: not one of them is broken (Psalm 24: 19-20).

The fact that you are righteous does not mean that you will be tree from afflictions. In fact, to be honest with you, immediately you become righteous, your afflictions will be increased.

The more the power of God in your life, the more the enemy will battle you. The greater your anointing, the greater the warfare. The brighter your destiny, the harsher your attackers.

But what is the law of the Lord? The above verse says, "But the Lord delivereth him out of them all." What this means is hundred-percent deliverance "out of them all."

Then, the second verse says, "He keepeth all his bones: not one of them is broken." I pray that all powers that want to break your bones shall be broken in Jesus' name.

We have established that affliction is part of the life of the righteous. Now, the book of Nahum 1:9 says:

What do ye imagine against the Lord? He will make an utter end: affliction shall not rise up the second time.

Why will the affliction not rise up the second time? It is because the Lord would have killed it.

The third Scripture is in the book of James 5:13, it says,

Is any among you afflicted? Let him pray. Is any merry? Let him sing psalms.

Mark what the above verse says: "Is any among you afflicted? Let him pray..." It does not say, "Let him worry," or "Let him cry," "Let him smoke *marijuana*." Although it doesn't say which kind of prayer.

12 CHARACTERISTICS OF AFFLICTION

1. Affliction causes pain.
2. Affliction causes suffering.
3. Affliction causes a person to be knocked about.
4. Affliction causes harassment.

5. Affliction causes a person to be knocked down.
6. Affliction causes a person to be weakened.
7. Affliction causes a person to be troubled.
8. Affliction causes a person to be burdened.
9. Affliction causes a person to be depressed.
10. Affliction causes a person to be oppressed.
11. Affliction causes a person to be tormented.
12. Affliction causes a person to be smitten by the enemy.

The Bible now makes us to understand that rising up of affliction is a fact. It also makes us understand that there is the second coming of affliction, hence that powerful prayer in the book of Nahum that "affliction shall not rise a second time."

The second coming of infirmity is a fact. The question to now ask is this: What kind of affliction rises again?

AFFLICTIONS THAT RISE AGAIN ARE:

Affliction that is on a killing mission. This means that, after the first affliction, the person is not dead yet, so this time around, it is coming to kill him outright.

Programmed affliction. This is the type of affliction that has received instructions from the devil to run after the person, to torment him and make sure that he has no peace.

Bound but not dead affliction. Jesus said, "Behold, I give unto you power to tread upon serpents and scorpions, and over every power of the enemy, and nothing shall by any means hurt you." When you tread upon a scorpion, crush and kill it, you've only got rid of just one member of the enemy camp.

Let me tell you some hard facts: The enemy does not want you in the hospital - he wants you in a coffin. And as far as you have a destiny to pursue, I want you to know that there are killing agents working against you. It is for this reason that God Himself is the ultimate killing machine.

There are a large number of enemies who will not leave you alone unless they die.

The obsession of most killing agents around is to take hold of you first and kill you. And should you give a space in your life, they will not let you go until they have completed their evil assignment.

This makes the issue of backsliding really dangerous for a believer. You may not find your way to Jesus before you die. If you don't rise up with the Lord's might within you, and kill these

killing powers, you will be killed.

One woman came to one church for prayer many years ago. Every Sunday, she went there to dance her soul away. When she eventually came to our church for counselling, I told her she needed prayer more than dancing. All the woman could say was that she hoped to dance her way to victory. I knew quite well that unless this woman started to pray, she would die very soon, I told her so.

As at that time, the woman used td come to church once in a week. Soon after my meeting with her, I travelled out of the country. During this period, the woman stopped coming to church. By the time I came back and asked after her, I learnt she was already in the hospital stark mad.

When I went to see her I couldn't recognise her again; she looked far older than her age and her head was clean shaven. I looked at her and reminded her of all my past warnings to her. God, in His mercy, delivered the woman from her predicament.

No affliction is too small to overlook. Ordinary fever can kill as much as cancer. So also can head-ache and poverty. All of these demand our instant attention as soon as we see signs of them in our lives.

Three brothers lived inside a room. There was no day they were not at one another's throat. Why? It was always because one of them used to eat more food than the other two, whereas each of them contributed equally to the meals.

One day, they all fought one another until they had no strength to fight again. A man of God came unto the scene and pleaded with them to kill their poverty rather than one another. For instance, the man of God counselled, if each one of them bought a bag of rice each week, none of them would complain about another eating too much.

Hypertension, divorce, diabetes, failure and poverty are killers. If you don't rise up in the power of the Lord and kill them, you stand being killed first. That is why the Bible says, "For this cause is the Son of man manifest, that He might destroy the works of the devil." This shows that Jesus Himself is a destroyer - only that He came to destroy the works of the devil.

I might just as well share with you a not-so-pleasant testimony about a sister at MFM. She is 39 years old and has every good thing of life - good job, three cars, a house of her own, yet no man has ever asked for her hand in marriage.

One day, she came for a Power Must Change Hands programme at which a word of knowledge came about someone there at the programme who, if not released by those in charge of her case, would attend the burial ceremonies of all these adversaries within seven days. The sister did not bother to say Amen as she didn't believe the message could be for her. When she got home, she prepared tea.

As she was about to drink the tea to break her fast, the telephone rang. When she picked up the

receiver, the voice on the other side announced that her father has just died. The sister broke down and lamented the fact that the old man would not live to witness her wedding. While she was still crying, the telephone rang again only to be told, again, that her mother too had died. These two dead people were not living together. The two deaths, following so closely, hinted her that something, indeed was amiss. Despite her shock, the sister still took time to drink her tea.

While still trying to come to terms with the sudden strange deaths of her parents, the telephone rang for the third time, this time from America. It was to tell her that her uncle had just died. All this happened within one hour of that sister's return home from the Power Must Change Hands programme. Within three months, the sister got married.

Many years ago, I shared a testimony in our church about a very rich woman, certainly the richest in her family.

One day, she wanted to eat pounded yam in her house. As she prayed on her food and took the first morsel of pounded yam, a frog jumped out of nowhere and landed on top of the pounded yam. The woman could only stare at the animal in wonder.

At last, she took the plate of *egusi* soup and used it to smash the frog and used all her strength to press it down, believing that this would completely squash the frog. She gradually eased the pressure and took a look at the pounded yam hoping to see the little animal squashed into it. But there was no frog. It has disappeared. The woman did not know that the frog had entered her body.

From that time, the woman's right arm and leg became paralysed. She was thereafter taken from one place to the other for solution. When the woman was eventually taken to a Pentecostal church, she was asked by the pastor if she is born again. The woman looked at the pastor and wondered what sort of insult was this.

She thereafter regaled the pastor with the number of important positions she held in her church, mostly as the chairlady of many women's guilds. What she probably did not know was that if she headed a guild of thirty members, twenty-eight of them were witches, so each time she stood before them to address them, these people were busy firing arrows into her.

At any rate, the woman confessed Jesus as her Saviour. Immediately she did, the power of the Lord came upon her and she stood up and walked. She went home happy that day. Immediately she got home and sat down, somebody she hadn't seen for sixteen years came knocking on her door. When she went over to open the door, the person who came asked her, "How did you get out of that problem?" The woman, in return asked the person, "So you knew about it?"

This is what happened: when the prayer was being said for the woman, the frog came out and went back to those who sent it. When the senders now saw the frog coming back, they came to check what happened.

Jesus has killing power. He looked at the fig tree and spoke death to it and the tree died. When

one killing force meets another killing force, the lesser killing force must bow. Moses faced Pharaoh and told him that if Pharaoh did not wish to see his face again, it would be so. And it was so.

Goliath was not in that field to play with David. If David did not kill Goliath, Goliath would have killed David. Elijah did not joke with the prophets of Baal; he dealt with them. If he didn't deal with them, they would have dealt with him. If you see anybody who goes to hell fire, the person must have gone there because he failed to kill sin, and that sin which remained alive captured him.

WHAT KINDS OF PRAYER KILL AFFLICTION?

Prayers to exercise authority. When a person says, "I take authority over that affliction," the person is killing that affliction.

Prayers to disobey their command. When a person is pressed to fall sick, and he refuses, he is disobeying the command of the enemy.

Prayers to undo the works of darkness. I love that English word 'undo'. What this means is that, though the enemy has done something, but now you undo it.

Prayers to silence the angel of death.

Prayers that address the earth and the sea.

Prayers that address the heavenlies. These are prayers that talk to the sun, the moon and the stars.

Prayers to force evil powers to vomit what they have swallowed. A lot of people have been brought for prayers after they've been shared out and eaten in the night. So when we pray that all those who have gathered to eat such a person should vomit what they've eaten, the person that had been eaten will regain his life.

Prayers to force wicked powers to drink their own blood and eat their own flesh. Remember, the psalmist said," when my foes came upon me, to eat my flesh, they stumble and they fall." What this means is that there are powers that can eat the flesh. The book of Isaiah also says, "All those tho seek to drink your blood will drink their own blood until they get drunk with it."

Prayers to force evil powers to carry out your orders.

Prayers that issue judgement.

Prayers that divert evil arrows away.

A lot of people have various levels of affliction hut mastery and fervency in the above prayers will definitely be catastrophic for the enemy. God is the ultimate killing machine. In His killing activities, any power that wants to battle against Him would be completely destroyed.

All those who don't want affliction to rise against them need to pray fervently.

PRAYER POINTS

1. Every source of affliction in my life, die! in Jesus' name.
2. Arrows of affliction, backfire! in the name of Jesus.
3. Every agenda of affliction for my life, go back to your sender, in the name of Jesus.
4. You powers of affliction, go to the pit before your time, in the name of Jesus.
5. Every power of affliction, come out with all your root, in the name of Jesus.
6. You powers of affliction, I render you homeless by the blood of Jesus.
7. You power of affliction, receive triangular attack - by the Father, by the Son, by the Holy Ghost, by the Spirit, by the Blood, by the water, by the sun, by the moon and by the stars, in the name of Jesus.
8. You powers of affliction, eat your own flesh and drink your own blood, in the name of Jesus.
9. Every power that wants me to die, die! in my place after the order of Haman.
10. Let the weapon of affliction back fire, in the name of Jesus.
11. Every source of affliction, receive double destruction, in the name of Jesus.
12. Powers of affliction, dig your own grave, fall into it and bury yourself, in the name of Jesus.
13. Spirits of affliction, I despatch you into dry and waterless places, in the name of Jesus.
14. The power of God, arise and kill my affliction, in the name of Jesus.
15. Every weapon of affliction fashioned against me, die! in the name of Jesus.
16. Every power that wants me dead, die in my place! in the name of Jesus.
17. Every inherited affliction, my life is not your candidate; therefore, die! in the name of Jesus.
18. Thou power of multiple afflictions, die, in Jesus' name.
19. Every blood-drinking affliction, every flesh-eating affliction, attack yourselves, in the name of Jesus.

DOMINION PROSPERITY

This chapter is for people who hate poverty with perfect hatred. It is for those who want the Lord to bless them so that they can bless His work.

It is for those who feel burdened to do one thing or the other for God but who feel hindered in one way or the other.

It is for those who believe that the vision of God for their life is to prosper and they want to pursue that prosperity.

One point is worth mentioning at the onset: poverty does not glorify God. A poor man can go to heaven, and a rich man can go to heaven. It depends on whether you have money or the money has you.

He raiseth up the poor out of the dust; and lifted the needy out of the dunghill; that he may set him with princes, even with the princes of his people (Psalm 113:7-8).

WHAT IS DOMINION PROSPERITY?

The first question to ask is: What do we mean by 'dominion prosperity'?

☞ Dominion prosperity is the prosperity that does not depend on the economy.

☞ It is the prosperity that does not depend on anything or anyone.

☞ It is the prosperity that does not respect scarcity.

☞ It is the prosperity that is unbeatable by the mad wind of life.

☞ It is the prosperity that has no regard for the environment or for adverse situations.

☞ It is the prosperity that does not care whether there is employment or not.

☞ It is the prosperity that can never be silenced by the agents of poverty.

☞ It is the prosperity that dominates.

☞ It is the prosperity that disobeys counterfeit commands.

☞ It is the prosperity that empowers you to take your rightful position.

☞ It is the prosperity that cannot be erased by man.

☞ It is the prosperity that forces darkness to vomit what it has swallowed.

For you to prosper correctly in the kind of environment we are in, you need this kind of prosperity. Our environment is wicked to the core. Winners are sometimes converted to losers. Shining stars are shot down. Anyone who rises high is pulled down with aggression. Any prosperous person is harassed by forces who want to equalise the person with the masses.

In addition, the children of darkness have employed all kinds of satanic techniques to steal the prosperity of others. In this kind of environment you need dominion prosperity so that you can overshadow every siren of poverty being blown against you.

Four years ago someone came to our church to ask for assistance. All he wanted was just two thousand naira to begin to sell biscuits. He started off with that two thousand naira. He prayed dominion prosperity prayers.

Within three months, beloved, this fellow was already paying tithes of ₦50,000. This is in contrast to the case of some people who started a trade with ₦20,000 but, because of the activities of the angels of poverty blowing the siren of poverty against them, they were soon reduced to nothing.

You need to pray prosperity prayers to know what God wants to do in your life. Let's look at the example of Isaac in the Bible to know that God wants His people to prosper. Whether you are rich or poor, you will go to heaven if you fulfill the conditions.

And there was a famine in the lend, beside the first famine that was in the days of Abraham. And Isaac went unto Abimelech king of the Philistines unto Gerar. And the LORD appeared unto him, and said, Go not down into Egypt; dwell in the land which I shall tell thee of: Sojourn in this land, and I will be with thee, and will bless thee; for unto thee, and unto thy seed, I will give all these countries, and I will perform the oath which I sware unto Abraham thy father; And I will make thy seed to multiply as the stars of heaven, and will give unto thy seed all these countries; and in thy seed shall all the nations of the earth be blessed (Genesis 26:1-4).

There was already famine in the land and Isaac prepared himself to go down to Egypt but the Lord told him not to go, that he should stay where he was, that there was a prosperity called dominion prosperity, that even in that famine land Isaac could still prosper.

In verse 12 of the same chapter, the Bible tells us:

Then Isaac sowed in that land, and received in the same year an hundredfold: and the Lord blessed him. And the man waxed great, and went forward, and grew until he became very great: for he had possession of herds, and great store of servants: and the Philistines envied him.

So the Lord blessed Isaac right there in the land of famine. This is an example of dominion prosperity. Dominion prosperity does not respect austerity. Dominion prosperity recognises the God of suddenlies whose power can arrive at anytime to surprise His children.

I know of a brother who was as poor as wretchedness. In fact, he was wretchedness personified. His poverty notwithstanding, this brother kept doing what God wanted him to do. In just one day, God did something, one child of the devil who had acquired wealth suddenly died. He divided his wealth into two giving half to his dog.

Concerning the other half, he wrote something in a piece of paper, put it in a bottle and threw it into the midst of the sea. On the piece of paper he put in the bottle was the instruction that whoever found the bottle should have the other half of his wealth. It was that moment that the brother was strolling across the beach. He saw the bottle. Overnight, that brother went from the dust to success.

For those who want dominion prosperity, it is time for them to possess their possession.

HOW TO OBTAIN DOMINION PROSPERITY

There is prosperity and there is prosperity. But there is a kind of prosperity known as dominion prosperity. How do you obtain this kind of prosperity? This is where you have to read this carefully.

If you want dominion prosperity, the first thing you should do is this:

Find out and experience God as your provider. The Bible says, "My Lord shall provide for all your needs according to His riches in glory." There is something known as divine provision as opposed to human provision. You can only experience dominion prosperity when you experience divine provision. Many people work so hard yet cannot make a living.

Sometime ago, a Nigerian fell down in the centre of London and died there. By the time her pockets were searched, she had four identity cards from four companies where she worked per day. Working in four places per day meant she probably slept for only two to three hours per day. And now that she was dead all the money she so exerted herself to earn would certainly go to someone else.

This is not what dominion prosperity is all about. Hers was the kind of poverty that kills. It is not a bad thing to be hard working. Indeed, all Christians should work hard. But all I want you to know is that until you experience divine provision that hard work may not be blessed. That is why we have a disease called profitless hard work. Therefore, we need divine provision.

Let there be a distinction in your mind between divine provision and human provision. If God is going to be your provider, you must invoke the principles that will make the Lord to provide for you. One of this principles is finding God and making Him your provider.

The second key to dominion prosperity is to be an aggressive tither. The tithe is the one tenth of your income. When a person fails to pay his tithe all he is doing is writing letters to poverty. The Bible tells us that if we pay our tithes the Lord will open the windows of heaven from where the rain of heaven will fall upon you so much that you will not even have space enough to contain it.

When you refuse to pay your tithe, the reverse is the case: God will lock up the windows of heaven. You can see that yow will be doing yourself a world of favour when you pay your tithe regularly, faithfully, aggressively.

Anything that comes to you, God has given you just 9/10th of it. But when you take what belongs to God as your own, you are a celebrated thief. And anyone stealing from God can steal from anybody. Even if you are a student, you must endeavour to pay your tithe from the pocket money given to you. To spend it is to steal, even if it is a gift.

Most of our holiness preaching churches, even though they believe in holiness, they hardly pay

their tithes. That's why, even when they live holy, they remain very poor. Then there are other Christians who are not as serious as these but who tithe constantly and aggressively, and because this is a principle of heaven, they prosper. We need to recognise this fact and do it the way God wants us to do it.

Unfortunately, many Christians do not pay their tithes. One thing we need to know is that God is not in need of anything. If God needed anything He would not ask you. No matter what you acquire, you will have to leave them behind one day. So why not build a house for yourself in heaven now where moth and rust cannot destroy. What God is asking us to do is for our own benefit. He says, "Test me and see."

Money must not be a god to us. That tithe is God's money and we must give it. None of us can go to heaven with all the earthly possessions we struggle day and night to acquire. The Bible does not encourage displaying our wealth before everybody. Don't wait till one preacher grabs a microphone to say he needs 100 people who will give him N500,000 so that you can march forward. This is sheer exhibitionism. The Bible says let not your right hand know what your left hand is doing.

When you pay your tithes you get the heavens opened. There is a law known as the law of tithing. It releases the prosperity of heaven to you. Holding back tithe is holding back God's money. Refusal to pay tithe is an invitation to poverty. This is what the Bible has made us to understand.

Those who want dominion prosperity must be aggressive tithers.

The third key is to obey the laws of offerings. In Luke 6:38, the Bible tells us:

Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom. For with the same measure that ye mete withal it shall be measured to you again.

Christians must learn to be generous by giving offerings to the Lord. In Proverbs 11:24, we read again:

There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty.

Obey the law of prosperity. And when you give to God, give with no string attached. It is when you do this that the law of offering will be released on your behalf. What the Bible is telling us is this: the giver becomes richer, purse keepers become poorer. This is a divine principle. The law is that the more you give to the Lord, the richer you become.

So after your tithe, which is really not yours, you still give out of the 9/10 back to God as offering. So while your tithe opens the windows of heaven to you, offering will invoke the law of giving and receiving on your behalf. And when you give, know that God is not a beggar - give to Him willingly, cheerfully. Don't wait to be intimidated or manipulated before you give to God. Give to Him willingly. Give to God without any grudge. Give to God sacrificially. Give to God generously. Give to God systematically. Give to God at every opportunity. Give to Him without display or open show, and He too will invoke that law of giving whereupon men and women will begin to bless you.

Key number four is to be a builder in the Kingdom of God. There are two kinds of builders in the Kingdom of God: spiritual builders and physical builders. Spiritual builders are those involved in preaching, fasting, praying and counselling, witnessing, intercession and deliverance. Physical builders are those who get involved in constructing temple unto the Lord. Haggai 1:6-8 explains to us why many Christians are very poor:

Ye have sown much, and bring in little; ye eat, but ye have not enough; ye drink, but ye are not filled with drink; ye clothe you, but there is none warm; and he that earneth wages earneth wages to put it into a bag with holes. Thus saith the LORD of hosts; Consider your ways. Go up to the mountain, and bring wood, and build the house; and I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified, saith the LORD.

God wants His people to participate in building for Him. God will always bless in abundance those who participate in building His church. You want God's eye to be on you for good? Be a builder of His church. Builders who build for God always enjoy divine supplies. You may not have money to put down in the construction work, your coming to the site to assist physically will win you His blessings all the same. There is no one who obeys this principle that God does not build a house for.

Our church moved to its Yaba headquarters in April 1994, when we started the clearing and construction work in 1993, many members who could not put money into the construction work came to join us in carrying bricks, blocks, sand, cement, wood, *etc.* as their own contribution to the building of his house.

Of all those people who took part in the building of the church, I can hardly point at one whom God has not assisted towards building their personal houses. Even when you don't join others on the construction site, you can look around your house, pick up anything that you don't need and either bring it or sell it and bring the proceeds into the house of God.

All those women who keep expensive jewelleries at home while their Father's house is in ruins will have themselves to blame. At any point the Lord orders them to stop breathing, all those jewelleries they have been locking up will become useless to them.

Any time that you hear that people are building for God, please rush there and assist and then see what God will do in your life

Key number five: Be a blessing to men of God. There are certain individuals that God works with. As you come across these people and bless them, the Lord, too, will bless you. If you look after an instrument of God, God himself will look after you.

I remember when I collected my first salary. When I took it home, my father insisted that we would not touch the money. We prayed over it and took it to the pastor. I just happened to walk into the pastor's office. At that very moment, the pastor was stone broke. Immediately I offered it to him, the man of God simply asked me to kneel down. The kind of prayer that he prayed that day was astoundingly serious, in short he prayed until he was sweating. I am sure that prayer is still working in my life right now. Another thing that he told me that day was that I shall live long. And I received it loud and clear.

In 2Kings 4, we see a woman who went out of her way to bless Elisha and the Lord blessed that woman. In 1 Kings 7, we see a woman who went out of her way to bless Elijah, and God blessed her. In Luke 5, we see Peter going out of his way to minister to Jesus, and God went forward to bless him.

Physical manifestations open doors to blessings when you bless an instrument of the Almighty. When you bless a genuine man or woman of God, it brings dominion prosperity into your life.

I am not unaware of the complaints some make that when they offer gifts to some pastors at MFM they often refuse them. It is not our intention to make the men of God at MFM commercial prophets. Likewise, we don't want to encourage people to take things from just anybody, because, through gifts from a person who is not yet born again, contamination can come in. What we can do is to wait for that person to get born again.

Many years ago, in our church, somebody drove in a V-boot Mercedes Benz car and brought me the key. He said the car was for me. But when I looked at the person from head to toe, he smelt of adultery. In addition to this, he had a big chain around his neck. I told him to hold on to the car. I advised him to keep coming to the service and surrender his life to Jesus first. I told him that after he had become one of us, we could then start taking things from him. Anything that you take and which closes your mouth is a wrong one.

The sixth principle is to break the curse and covenants of poverty. It is obvious that some people are under such covenants. They need to break it. If you come from a family where poverty is the trade mark, you must know that you are working under a curse or covenant of poverty. You need to break it; and as you break it and follow up with regular tithing and offering, the Lord will open doors for you.

The seventh key is the sowing the seed of faith.

While the earth remaineth, seed time and harvest, and cold and heat, and summer and winter, and day and night shall not cease.

The first thing the above verse mentions is "seed time and harvest". Do you want a harvest time? The first thing you need to do is plant a seed. Without seed time there cannot be harvest. This is both a physical and natural law. Believers who understand this principle just take a bulk thing and sow it in the work of the Lord as a seed.

This God-established principle of sowing and reaping is a key to dominion prosperity. So a good seed planted in good ground will produce a harvest.

When you've sown your seed, then you speak in agreement with that seed, speak in agreement with the Bible, speak in agreement with the law of prosperity and dominion prosperity will be released upon you.

The last but not the least key to dominion prosperity is to pray the prayer of dominion

prosperity. It is important for us to know that the Mountain of Fire and Miracle Ministries is a place where you come and get blessed. The other time, we asked people to give a chair or more at the Prayer City.

I remember a man who brought us one dozen chairs at that time. When this man was sharing his testimony, he told people that when he first came to MFM he could not change his shirt and trousers for three months. These were all that the man had before he came to join us. But as the God of prosperity began to move in his life, he began to get blessed up to the level where he could buy a dozen chairs for the church.

You may have to close your eyes to what people are saying in order to sow into the things of God. A sister came to our church the other time. She wrote a cheque in the name of MFM. When her bank manager took the money from her, he told her,

"You are a mad woman. How can you give a church this much? This is sheer madness."

The woman told him,

"Mr Bank Manager, you were here while I was always coming here to borrow money. You were the one approving the loan. Then, all of a sudden, you discovered that God has blessed me. Now you are telling me not to bless that God that blessed me. Sorry, I shall not go back to the borderline of poverty."

The woman went ahead and sowed the seed.

Many people are supposed to be strikingly rich but they keep sitting on what they should give to God. And the more they keep their Ishmaels the more their Isaac shall be hidden. The consequence of that is that they will spend the whole of their lifetime changing the nappies of those Ishmaels.

A lot of people are tithe stealers who should pray to God for forgiveness. If you belong in this category, deceive yourself no more, lay your hand on your chest and pray to God to open your windows of heaven. No matter how small your salary is, you just go ahead and test God with the one tenth of it and see what He will do.

If God is asking you for just one tenth but you keep joining His own one tenth to your own nine tenths, all He will do is remove everything from you. And this will be very sad.

Christians need to understand the principles of dominion prosperity. I would like you to go over this message over and over again and practicalise it and see what the Lord will do with your destiny.

PRAYER POINTS

1. Every ancient serpent and scorpion in my family line, I crush your head, in the name of Jesus.
2. Every habitation of serpents and scorpions in my household, become desolate, in the name of Jesus.
3. Henceforth, no serpent and scorpion must trouble me, for I bear in my body the mark of my Lord Jesus Christ.
4. (Lay a hand on your head) Serpentine poison, get out of my body, in the name of Jesus.
5. (Lay a hand on your stomach) Serpentine poison, come out of my body, in the name of Jesus.
6. O God, arise and make me very great, in the name of Jesus.
7. O God, arise and move me forward in spite of my circumstances, in the name of Jesus.
8. I bury every satanic famine, in the name of Jesus.
9. No matter the kind of government we have, I'll make it, in the name of Jesus.
10. I make divine advancement by fire! in the name of Jesus.
11. No matter my background, no matter my family, no matter my education, O God, arise, lift me up by fire! in the name of Jesus.
12. I rise out of the dust of poverty by the power in the Blood of Jesus.
13. Thou power of dominion prosperity, come upon my life, in the name of Jesus.

PROVOKING DIVINE INTERVENTION

Behold, I will send my messenger, and he shall prepare the way before me: and the LORD, whom ye seek, shall suddenly come to his temple, even the messenger of the covenant, whom ye delight in: behold, he shall come, saith the LORD of hosts (Malachi 3:1).

In Psalm 6:10, we read:

Let all mine enemies be ashamed and sore vexed: let them return and be ashamed suddenly.

There are four unchanging facts about the operation of the Almighty.

God never comes before time;

God never comes late;

Cod never fails;

God sometimes acts suddenly.

When you read the Bible very well, you will understand these principles of God.

Pentecostalism started in Nigeria in 1918. Before that time, missionaries had been coming to Nigeria. But the missionaries did not understand the spiritual geography of the environment in which they were operating. This led some of them to make tragic mistakes; they did a lot of things wrong. They did not know that the idol of a man which he had hidden under his bed was worshipped by him before coming to church on Sunday. Even, in some instances, worshippers were given images they came to church to see. The missionaries did not understand the spiritual problem of the people, hence they could not address them.

Well, we thank God for the schools they built but the spiritual darkness remained the same. Men and woman were dying like houseflies; people could not go out at night. If you wore out a good dress in the night, you'd be dead by the morning. People who had children often had all of them dying mysteriously. Witches flew in the daytime and all manners of things did happen. You dared not call witches by their name, lest you regretted it. A thick spiritual darkness prevailed until God began to raise men who understood the spiritual geography of their environment.

One of such men was Joseph Babalola. Of course, some prayer meetings had started before God called him. This group was called 'Faith Tabernacle'. However, as they progressed, this group got confused.

One day they held a meeting to sort out this confusion. One of the items on the agenda was

whether they should allow polygamists to take communion. Another matter they tabled for discussion was divine healing, that is whether God could heal without medicine, *etc*. Joseph Babalola was invited to that meeting. But because he was too junior for the meeting, he stayed in the vestry.

Altogether, there were twenty-four items on the agenda for that day. The issue of whether polygamists should be allowed to take communion was top on the agenda. This one was resolved against polygamists -no communion for them. Period.

The debate shifted to divine healing. While this went on, there came a loud, agonised cry outside the venue. A coffin was being taken to the cemetery for burial. The dead person was the bread winner of his family who died at a very young age.

At this particular time, Joseph Babalola was still in the vestry, away from the meeting. But when he heard the cry from outside, he stood up from where he was and went to the front of the church where the meeting was going on. He asked the burial procession to put the coffin down. The people obeyed. He laid a hand on it and commanded life upon it in the name of Jesus. The lifeless corpse in the coffin jumped up. This effectively put an end to the debate going on inside the church on whether there was divine healing or not. After all, they were still debating on healing when God had raised up the dead.

Immediately this miracle happened, the senior men at the meeting became interested in hearing from Joseph Babalola. He took his position in their midst and began to talk at about 10 a.m. He did not stop until 4 p.m. Throughout his speech, no one stood up or went to the toilet. Everyone wanted to listen to this strange man.

Before the meeting was over, word had gone round about what was happening in that place. That was how the great revival that rocked Ilesha in 1930 began. The woman who lost her son was crying hopelessly on the way to burying her dead son but there came a divine intervention. God is a God of the suddenlies.

In 2 Chronicles 29:36, we read:

And Hezekiah rejoiced, and all the people, that God has prepared the people: for the thing was done suddenly.

The sudden revival that God began was not planned for by anybody. In the book of Numbers, some members of the household of Moses grouped together against Moses, but the Bible tells us:

(And the man Moses was very meek, above all the men which were upon the face of the earth). And the Lord spake suddenly unto Moses, and unto Aaron, and unto Mirian, Come out ye three unto the tabernacle of the congregation. And they three came out.

These people had been grouping against Moses, harassing him until God intervened in the matter to assist Moses.

In Psalm 64:7, the Bible promises:

But God shall shoot at them with an arrow; suddenly shall they be wounded.

God shoots sudden arrows. At the time the enemies rejoice, God will suddenly shoot an arrow and they shall be wounded.

In Luke, we also read:

And it came to pass in those days, that there went out a decree from Caesar Augustus that all the world should be taxed. (And this taxing was first made when Cyrenius was governor of Syria.) And all went to be taxed, every one into his own city. And Joseph also went up from Galilee, out of the city of Nazareth, into Judea, unto the city of David, which is called Bethlehem; (because he was of the house and lineage of David:)...And suddenly there was with the angel a multitude of the heavenly host praising God, and saying, Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace,...(Luke 2: 1-4, 13-14).

God suddenly sent His angels when Christ was born. Same thing happened when Paul, then Saul was about to be converted.

And as he journeyed, he came near Damascus: and suddenly there shined around about him a light from heaven: and fell to the earth, and heard a voice saying unto him, Saul, Saul, why persecuteth thou me?" (Acts 9:3).

God is a God of the suddenlies. Again, in the book of Acts 16:25 the Bible tells us:

And at midnight Paul and Silas prayed, and sang praises unto Cod: and the prinsoners heard them. And suddenly there was a great earthquake ..."

The deliverance of Paul and Silas was sudden. When we go back to the Acts of the Apostles 2:1-2, we shall read:

And when the day of Pentecost was fully come, they were all with one accord in one place. And suddenly there came a sound from heaven as of a rushing mighty wind ...

Even the arrival of the Holy Ghost was sudden. And by the time you have gone through the Bible, you shall discover that the beginning of the church was sudden, just as sudden as will be the sounding of the trumpet signifying the rapture.

What does it mean to be sudden? It means something happening or coming unexpectedly, at the least expected time, something happening quickly without warning.

Beloved, the information I have for you as you read this is that you should expect God to move suddenly in your affairs. You can change suddenly; your situation can change for the better suddenly. Even today, God can do something suddenly.

When a situation becomes stubborn and oppressive, when it seems like you are being pushed around, when you cry so much that tears no longer issue from your eyes, when you have been boxed into a corner by the enemy, when you have looked all around you and seen no one to help you, and you have tried everything you know to try, yet there is no way out, it is at a time like this that you need what is called sudden divine intervention. It is at this point that you need the heaven to come down to you at the nick of time.

Many years ago, a man came to our church for prayer. He wanted to travel abroad. I prayed for him and the Lord intervened. He travelled. Immediately the man arrived overseas, it was as if the security agents were waiting for him. The man was instantly arrested - for drug-trafficking.

As they dragged him away, he cried miserably, "Upon all the prayers the MFM G. O. prayed for me? This is rather sad. What have I done, Lord?" It was after the man had been in detention for sometime that they discovered he wasn't the person they were after. He was released. It was while he was going through the newspaper the following day that he realised what was happening. He had missed the original flight that was to take him to the foreign country.

In fact, that flight had crashed and killed all the people on board. As a matter of fact, the man's name was on the manifest of the crashed plane. The enemy had already programmed that plane to crash, but God had to move in suddenly to deliver His son from imminent death.

WHAT IS DIVINE INTERVENTION?

☞ The sudden movement of God into your situation

☞ The unexpected visitation of messengers from heaven

☞ Experiencing signs and wonders you don't expect

☞ A miracle that comes when you have already given up

☞ The move of God that goes beyond your expectation

There was a ministration in New York. A sister had been failing her exams seven times. By the time she was about to take the eighth one, the word of God came that she would not fail this one. The sister claimed the promise. But by the time the result came out, the sister did not only fail, she was advised not to take the exam again.

The sister went back to the man of God, wondering why the same God who promised her failed her again. The man of God told her, "God never fails." By the next morning, the sister received a letter in her mail - it was an apology from the examination board, for sending her a result that was not hers.

☞ A miraculous experience that brings tears of joy

☞ A move of God that shows God as the El-Shaddai. El-Shaddai means God that is more than enough.

☞ The sudden arrival of the Lord and the scattering of the enemies

☞ God coming from unexpected quarters, at an unexpected time to help you

☞ God coming through the back door when you are looking through the front door; it is God coming through the roof when you are looking through the window.

We will need divine intervention in our situations. Kindly read the following prophetic statements carefully and say amen to each one:

God will not come late into your situation, in the name of Jesus.

By the power and blood of Him that died and rose again, divine intervention is coming your way, in the name of Jesus.

By the power of God, the entire host of heaven is ready to intervene in your matter, in the name of Jesus.

By the power of the Holy Ghost, the Lord shall address the source of your tears.

By the power of God, every good thing that has died in your life shall come alive, in the name of Jesus.

By the power of God, you shall rise and shine again, in the name of Jesus.

HOW TO PROVOKE DIVINE INTERVENTION

This brings us to the question: How can I provoke divine intervention on my behalf? While I was returning from my studies in the UK in 1984, a white lady looked at me at the airport and asked, "Are you aware that you are entitled to only 20 kilograms?" I told her I did not know.

In fact, what happened was that during the whole of the three years that it took to do my PhD I did not travel even for one day, either for a holiday or any other thing. So when my course was over, I packed all the things I could and headed for home. Now, at the airport, the whole thing weighed 65 kilograms! The lady said what this meant was that I was not prepared to go home yet. I apologised to the lady and asked what I should do. She answered that I had to pay for the excess luggage. When I told her that I had just one pound on me she disgustedly told me to clear away from her sight so that she could attend to others.

Not knowing what else to do, I joined hands with the other brothers coming with me at the airport and said, "O God of the heavenlies, appear, in Jesus' name. Amen."

With the small change left on us, we bought biscuits and tea and waited. We had no idea that this white lady was watching us as we prayed. Even though we had moved to one side as she ordered us, we were satisfied that we had called on the God of suddenlies to appear suddenly.

Suddenly, some people arrived at the airport who had no luggage at all. We heard the white lady ask these people if she could use their allowance for some other persons. These people said they did not need it.

Then, suddenly again, the white lady came to meet us where we were eating biscuits and asked us to bring all luggage. She took them away. As we turned back to go away, the white lady called us back and told us to pray for her too.

As I once said in one of my messages, God allowed Satan's pregnancy to be nine months old before He aborted it.

How do I provoke divine intervention?

By living a life of repentance and humility. The Bible says, "If my people, which are called by my name, shall humble themselves..." Humility is very essential. If you are proud before God, all you are telling God is that you can solve all your problems. In this case, He will see no cause to intervene in your case.

One day, there was a terrible war which drove two people into the forest. Some evil wind was blowing and felling down trees. One of the two people who ran into the forest was a Christian, the second person was a witchdoctor. As the trees were falling, the Christian kept shouting "The blood of Jesus, the blood of Jesus." as he ran on. Each time he shouted "The blood of Jesus," he would have passed before the tree would fall. The herbalist noticed that it was what this Christian was saying that made the trees miss him. But he kept chanting his incantations, yet the trees kept falling on him.

When he now saw how much better the Christian was faring, he too began to shout "The blood of Jesus." What the herbalist did was to demonstrate repentance and humility. One reason to demonstrate repentance and humility is that God is not under any obligation to bless a rebellious person.

By engaging in ceaseless, fervent prayer and fasting. No body gathered in a vigil when James was arrested, so James died. But when Peter was caught, the people gathered in prayer; Peter was free.

Engaging in long sessions of praises and worship.

By giving sacrificially.

By asking for divine intervention, like we prayed at the airport.

By going out of your way to be a blessing unto others. You should know that the more people you make happy, the happier you will be yourself. Conversely, the more people you create sadness for, the sadder you will be yourself. All those who were mightily blessed in the Bible were people who first went out of their way to be a blessing unto others.

The widow of Zarephat had just the last meal to eat with her son and die when this smelling prophet who had not taken his bath for three and a half years came along to ask for some water. As she went to fetch this, the prophet added, "And some oil, and bread . . ."

The woman said what the prophet wanted was, indeed, a meal but she had just the last of this at home. But, at any rate, she said because of what the prophet said, she would bring that last meal. Immediately the woman took that decision, to go out of her way to be a blessing, prophetic words pursued her that the jar or meal would not dry up and the oil would not cease.

Peter had fished all night and caught nothing. As he was disappointedly washing his net to go home, Jesus suddenly arrived to ask to use his boat as His pulpit. Some other person would have bitterly protested, more so when he had had a fruitless night of fishing, but Peter willingly offered his boat to Jesus Christ.

After delivering His message, Jesus asked him to throw his net. Though hesitant at first, as it was hardly the best time and spot to catch any fish, Peter nevertheless went out of his way to obey Jesus Christ. From that day, his austerity changed to prosperity.

Divine intervention comes as a demonstration of the Sovereign power of God, based purely on His mercy. One of my most horrible years in the civil service was when one magistrate living opposite our house decided to write petition against me... Her grouse was that I woke up every morning at 1 a.m. to shout and shout in the name of praying and in course of which I called her all manner of names - idiot, prostitute, rogue, *etc.* The closing line in those petitions she bombarded my office with was always that people like me were not fit to live in enlightened places like that but in slums.

One day, this petitioner came to my place of work with police to report verbally. Our administrator now asked her if she had met this Olukoya man before. She said yes, that the man was a trouble maker. The administrator asked if she was sure, she insisted she did. While they still discussed, I walked into the administrator's office.

As I came in, the administrator asked the woman if she knew that man who had just come in. The woman said she did not know me. Whereupon the administrator said, "But this is the Dr. Olukoya

you have been complaining about." The woman looked at me and said, "But this one doesn't look like a trouble maker." The next minute, however, she changed her mind and said I was, indeed, the man she had been complaining about. The pity was that the administrator was believing her against me. This made me suffer a great deal. But I was soon to be delivered from the woman's harassment.

The end of my problem came when I went to Cuba on a research assignment. At this time when everyone knew I was not within the country, the woman wrote another petition against me for the noise I made when I was not in the country! Let me advise you: Stop worshipping your problems; stop paying too much attention to your circumstances. Rather, give more attention to the name of Jesus. The Bible says, "The name of the Lord is a strong tower: the righteous runneth in and is saved." Whatever your problems are, when you give more attention to His name, they will collapse.

Learn to wait upon the Lord. The apostles waited for ten days before the spirit of God fell suddenly upon them. Waiting releases the anointing; it brings life, it brings power. When you don't wait, it becomes easy to have Ishmaels; but if you want an Isaac you have to wait on the promises of God. Never rush ahead of the timing of the Almighty. If you rush and get an Ishmael, you will spend the rest of your life changing the nappies.

Wait patiently believing that God will move at the appointed time. Stop trying to figure out God as if He were something you could put in a test-tube for an experiment. His ways are past finding out; and His ways are not our ways. God cannot be confined to a test tube or a medical doctor's report. Put that flesh under control. That judge, that boss or whoever has not the final say because he is not God.

In many horrible circumstances, we have watched God move. Through these, we have known that there is no terrible circumstance that can stand against the power of God for one second. When God moves, those circumstances have no chance at all.

When you start messing up with your own problem, you only strengthen and increase the size of that problem. Those who exercise true faith in the Lord always enter into their rest. When the sudden movement of God comes upon you, and the earthquake of deliverance begins to fight for you, those around you, too, will be set free, just like what happened to Paul and Silas along with whom other prisoners were set free.

Your divine intervention will bring glory to people around you. The Bible says, "Ask, and it shall be given unto you ..." but when you fail to ask, nothing happens. But as you keep calling upon the name of God, the God of suddenlies will move on your behalf.

This reminds me of that brother who had been looking for a wife. As he went for a prayer meeting, a sister praying with aggression gave him a blow at the back. Instantly, God told him that was his wife. This turned out to be true. Up till that time, no one had wanted to marry the brother.

PRAYER POINTS

1. (Point a finger heavenward) Today, I must receive my breakthrough, in the name of Jesus.
2. Every sorrow, I expel you by fire from my life, in the name of Jesus.
3. My miracle is about to happen, in the name of Jesus.
4. My Father, burst forth upon my life by signs and wonders, in the name of Jesus.
5. Thou power of double destruction, arise! destroy my Goliath, in the name of Jesus.
6. I shall not die before the manifestation of my miracles, in the name of Jesus.
7. (Raise up your right hand heavenward) I shall receive, I shall expect, I shall believe, I shall testify, in the name of Jesus.
8. Every destiny hijacker, I command you to die, in the name or Jesus.
9. Every local prince of Persia blocking my angel of breakthrough, I cast you down, in the name of Jesus.
10. O God of the suddenlies, arise! manifest your power, in the name of Jesus.

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